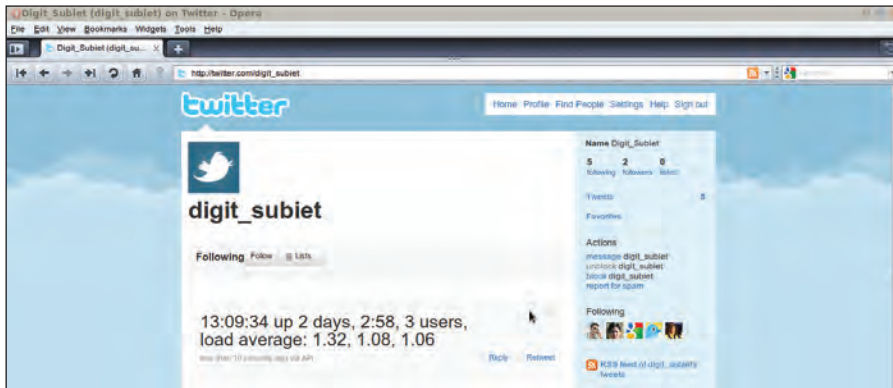


Google Gears

Read an interesting article on Google Gears, go to <http://www.thinkdigit.com/d/gears/>

.NET resources

If you're a .NET developer, read an informative post on the Digit forum at <http://www.thinkdigit.com/d/dotnetresources/>



A very useful application via an unintended use for Twitter

```
while 1 == 1:
    digit.
PostUpdate(getoutput('uptime'))

print(getoutput('uptime'))
time.sleep(300)
```

The above code updates a Twitter account with the system uptime information every 5 minutes (60x5). While 1 == 1 basically runs it as an infinite loop.

The final exercise

As our final exercise, we will make a Twitter bot, which is nothing but a Twitter account that starts following any user who posts a status update containing a particular phrase

```
import Twitter
import time

#to allow for sleeping
digit = Twitter.
Api(username='digit_subiet',
password='digit_subiet1')
while 1==1:
    statuses = digit.GetPublicTimeline()
    for status in statuses:
        if status.text.
```

```
find('digit') != -1:
    try:
        digit.CreateFriendship(status.
user.id)
    except
Exception:
    print "Error %s" %status.user.
name
    time.sleep(300)
#to prevent server abuse
status.text.find returns lower
index when it finds a string and
-1 when it doesn't. Some other
methods that you might find
useful are the following, they
are self-explanatory and work as
above.
api.GetUser(user)
api.GetReplies()
api.GetFriendsTimeline(user)
api.GetFeatured()
api.GetDirectMessages()
api.DestroyDirectMessage(id)
api.DestroyFriendship(user)
api.GetUserByEmail(email)
```

Rate limiting

To prevent abuse, Twitter limits the number of requests you can make to their servers. For the Rest API methods, the limit stands at 150 Http GET requests per hour, which effectively means updating your status doesn't count towards your limit. But requesting friends data and other requests where you are polling data from their servers do. When you hit the rate limit, your GET requests gets an HTTP 400 response code. The limit is enforced via IP and Authenticated

account.

For search API, there is no "disclosed" limit, but is far higher than 150. Effectively you can ignore the Search API limit. If you are finding yourself strangled by the Rest API limit ever too often, just fill in the "Whitelisting Request Form" available at http://twitter.com/help/request_whitelisting. Once approved, you can make up to 20,000 request per hour.

Further reading

Due to space constraints we have not covered all the options and possibilities of the Twitter API, if the above got you hooked and you are interested in exploring more, here are a couple of more suggestions for you.

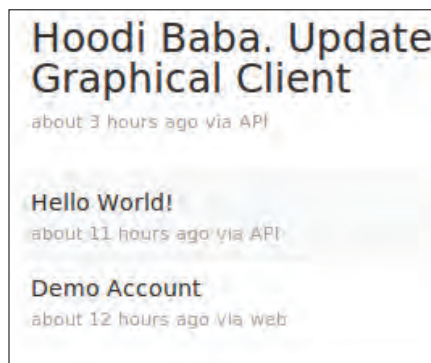


Indicates the use of Twitter API as a method of posting

One common question that comes to everyone's mind is how to append from [your_app_name] at the end of your tweet, when posting from your custom app, instead of the current from API. The first step towards that is registering your application at http://twitter.com/oauth_clients/new. You'll have to use the OAuth library to authenticate your app with the consumer key and secret key generated above. Details of this process should not be more than a Google away.

There are multiple Python wrappers available for the Twitter API, what we have covered over here is just one of them and should suffice for all purposes, but you want to explore more here is comparison with quick and dirty examples for other wrappers. [d](#)

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Indicates the use of Twitter API as a method of posting